EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 13 OCTOBER 2026

North zone, Mauritius (Pamplemousses and Rivière du Rempart)

The North's taps hang on one reservoir and one transfer from Midlands. Write the release rule and the priority list now, and make every drum filled this month a covered one.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
MUS.R8e39d7d595 (label unconfirmed): the rest of the main island plus Rodrigues, about 850,000 people	No figure published for Mauritius	Now to March 2027; water risk peaks before the rains	Water supply failure; dengue; cyclone and flood

17/17 recommendations checked. 1 confirmed, 9 corrected, 0 unverified, and 7 contraindicated (the seven *Do not* cards); 1 funding placement (the lid line) is unverified. Five further lens actions were dropped in verification: a leptospirosis alert (no 2026 cases in either district, and antibiotic trials show no effect on mortality), restarting sterile-mosquito releases at Panchvati (not feasible before the peak), household chlorine tablets (the North's water is piped and chlorinated), a heat early-warning plan (the Ahmedabad evidence does not transfer), and opening the Goodlands wholesale market (little effect on lives). **The funding target fell 72%**, from the panel's Rs 19.0M to Rs 5.28M (about $110,000). Verification cut it to Rs 7.5M: hospital water and chlorine tablets went as

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



20.06°S 57.58°E, Mauritius · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** La Nicolière was at 45.8% at end-September 2026 against 75.7% a year earlier, and the North gets 6 hours of water a day.
- **First action.** The CWA, the Water Resources Unit, and the Irrigation Authority write down the Midlands release rule and publish the rota's steps, by 31 October.
- **The money.** Rs 0.6M / 5.28M / 5.28M ($12k / $110k / $110k); all of it buys lids, pending a quote and a Ministry of Health check. Trigger cash comes from the national line.
- **Do not.** Do not give vegetables a third irrigation day: it comes out of the same reservoir as the North's drinking water.

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duplication and non-transferable, and the pre-arranged cash was cut back. The set audit of 14 October then moved the cash to one national trigger-cash line (MU-F01, Rs 5,000 a household, Rs 2.8M cap per trigger, shared by all six zones), sized on the largest comparable payout on record: Rs 2.795M to Rodrigues after the rains of 15 March 2026, of which Rs 795k came from the NEF and Rs 2M from the National Solidarity Fund. That line is not counted here. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It covers heat only and publishes no figure for Mauritius, so this report gives no excess-death number, scaled or otherwise. **Scope.** The Central Water Authority's North supply zone, about 259,000 people (WorldPop 2020 estimate): Pamplemousses (140,856 people, Census 2022, Statistics Mauritius) and Rivière du Rempart (111,195, same census) districts, with parts of Montagne Longue and Crève Coeur, and Terre Rouge, Baie du Tombeau, Le Hochet, Riche Terre, and Arsenal, which the CWA's schedule places in this zone, not Port Louis. 92,657 CWA subscribers over 340 km². One of six Mauritius briefings aligned to the CWA's supply zones. **The premise.** This is not an "El Niño drought". The North's water failures of 1999, 2011–12, and 2017–18 fell in La Niña years, and 2025 in a cool-neutral one. The reservoir is low because a dry summer followed a structural shortfall, and a hydrologist advises planning for no useful rain before early February. The Mauritius Meteorological Services' bulletin of 10 August 2026 puts October–December rain at about 92% of normal (near-normal to slightly dry) and temperatures above normal; the regional SARCOF-33 outlook gives normal to above-normal rain for January–March 2027.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

independently is the stronger bet.

1. By 31 October, write down the rule for releasing Midlands water into La Nicolière, and publish the North rota with steps tied to the reservoir level

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Central Water Authority, with the Water Resources Unit and the Irrigation Authority	31 October 2026	Staff time; no new money	An unplanned collapse of supply, and a rota no one can plan around

Since 2002 the North's supply has hinged on the central plateau's rain, not its own. La Nicolière (built in 1929) is topped up from Midlands dam, which was at about 80% in early October. La Nicolière was at 48.3% on 30 July, when the Water Resources Commission and the CWA warned it "could be dry by October if the drought persists". It did not run dry, which points to Midlands transfers, and it stood at 45.8% at end-September 2026 against 75.7% a year earlier. No published rule says how much Midlands water goes north, in what order, or what happens to the rota at each level. Write the rule down, including the Irrigation Authority's share (La Nicolière also feeds about 1,900 ha of the Northern Plains irrigation scheme). Then publish the rota with its steps: the current 04:00–07:00 and 16:00–19:00 schedule, and what replaces it below set levels.

Corrections: the Irrigation Authority is a party, because the reservoir also irrigates. A reported reading of "6%" on 3 October is a dropped digit; the figure the Water Resources Commission and the CWA give is 45.8% at end-September 2026. The 27 km feeder canal figure comes from late-1990s project sources. The evidence for the action is the record here; no comparable evaluated programme exists.

2. By 31 October, name the tankers, including registered private ones, for SSRN Hospital, dialysis units, health centres, and refuge centres

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
CWA, with the Ministry of Health and Wellness	31 October 2026	Within existing CWA and Ministry budgets	A hospital or dialysis unit left dry if supply fails

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The CWA has 31 tankers, 25–26 of them working, plus six on loan from the fire service, and 18 are committed to the Mare aux Vacoas area (the CWA's acting head, 11 October). The North draws on the rest. The CWA opened registration of private tankers on 6 October. A written roster gives SSRN Hospital in Pamplemousses, every dialysis unit, the area health centres, and the cyclone refuge centres a named tanker, private or public, and a fill schedule. This is a decision, not a purchase.

Correction: the roster has to include private tankers, because the public fleet is mostly on the plateau. Whether SSRN has its own storage or borehole was not found; the Ministry of Health should say so when it signs the roster.

3. Bring private and tested inland boreholes into supply now, but cap coastal abstraction and log chloride every month at every northern borehole

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
CWA (groundwater licensing), with the Water Resources Unit	15 November 2026	Within the Rs 6.4bn water-security vote	A supply gap now, without salting the aquifer the North will need next year

Groundwater supplies about 55% of demand and is running about 30% below normal (Water Resources Unit, August 2026). The CWA's acting head has said firms that abstract groundwater could be asked to put part of it into the public network, and the CWA has requisitioned private boreholes before. Do that first, and use inland boreholes that have been tested. Do not add coastal abstraction blind: the numerical model of the Northern Aquifer, a UNESCO project, runs to March 2027 and is not finished. Measured chloride in coastal areas, about 42 mg/L, is far below the 250 mg/L guideline, so a monthly log now is a baseline, not an alarm. The Ground Water Regulations 2011 already require every licensed borehole to have a meter, daily records, and a monthly return, enforced by the CWA.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the enforcer is the CWA, not the Water Resources Unit. A press report that 15 northern boreholes drilled in 2023–24 yield about 40,000 m³/day for Rs 16.6M could not be found, so it is not relied on. The CWA reports "no major difficulties" with hotels' boreholes, so enforcement is legitimate but is not a documented problem. The claim that the aquifers were at their "exploitation limit" in 2008 could not be verified.

4. Make "covered" part of every water-storage message, make a sealed lid a condition of the 9 October Rs 15,000 tank voucher, and sweep containers in Triolet, Goodlands, and the cités before December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Health and Wellness (vector control), with the CWA and the District Councils	Messages now; sweeps and grant condition by 30 November	About zero for the wording; lids Rs 5.28M in the funding section (a Rs 0.6M pilot at the floor)	Water stored for a 6-hour day becoming mosquito habitat by January

Every lens reached this one. Six hours of supply a day makes households fill drums and tanks, and the vector here, *Aedes albopictus*, breeds in exactly those containers. In June 2024 the Health Minister named Rivière du Rempart and Pamplemousses, with Vacoas, as the last areas still affected by the record 2023–24 dengue outbreak. On 9 October 2026 Cabinet decided on a Rs 15,000 Development Bank of Mauritius voucher for every household without a tank, run by the CWA and the DBM. It buys two tanks (1,000 and 500 litres) and a pump, tenants are eligible, and there is no income test (Mega Business, 11 Oct 2026). It replaces the earlier Rs 175M tank line. The lid condition is a national ask, made once for all six zones (MU-01). That will put thousands of new tanks into northern yards just before the mosquito season, and no lid or mesh condition was found in any version of the scheme. Every CWA storage message should say "covered, and scrubbed weekly"; tanker water should go into clean, lidded containers; and the yard sweeps should start before the November–April dengue peak. The UNDP-supported community hub at Cité Cœur Immaculée de Marie in Rivière du Rempart is a ready venue.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the basis is the North's 2024 dengue record, not the 2026 chikungunya epidemic, whose named hotspots are all on the plateau. No approval was found for putting larvicide (Bti or temephos) into stored drinking water in Mauritius, so keep larvicide to containers that do not hold drinking water unless the Ministry confirms. The evidence for covers is thin (one non-randomised Cuban study, odds ratio 0.22) and was generated with *Ae. aegypti*.*

5. Before December, give every street a named outage reporter who calls 170 and logs the reference, a buddy for everyone who lives alone, and a tanker log

CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Village Councils, with parishes, temple and mosque committees, and planters' and women's associations	30 November 2026	Volunteer time	Streets, and older people living alone, going dry because nobody complained

In this zone, water follows complaints. In May 2026 Rue Les Flamants in Pereybère had been without running water for nearly two months, and the CWA said its northern engineer had received one complaint. In February 2026 parts of Grand Gaube went more than three days dry after a pump failed, until residents went into the street and tankers came. A named reporter per street calls the CWA hotline (170) whenever the taps are dry outside the rota windows and keeps the complaint reference, because the CWA counts complaints. A buddy checks that each older person living alone has filled covered containers in both supply windows, and calls 170 for them. A tanker log records arrival time, volume, and any payment asked for: CWA tanker drivers in Vallée Pitot were investigated for selling water in 2025.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The evidence is local and operational, not a trial. The CWA's main line is 601 5000.

6. By 1 December, each district's disaster committee writes an activation rule: start on observed heavy rain or reported flooding, without waiting for a national warning

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Pamplemousses and Rivière du Rempart District Councils (Local DRRM Committees), with the NDRRMC	1 December 2026	None	Response starting after the water, as in Cyclone Belal

The North is short of water now, but the regional forecast for January–March 2027 is normal to above-normal rain, and GFDRR's 2017 risk profile finds direct losses from cyclones and floods proportionally largest in Pamplemousses and Rivière du Rempart. The structure already exists: the 2016 Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act gives each District Council a committee chaired by the council chair and a Local Emergency Operations Command. What it lacks is a local trigger. The only one on record is the national torrential-rain warning (100 mm in 12 hours), which gave no lead time in 2013 or in Belal in 2024. Each committee should write down the observed rainfall, or the reported flooding, at which its command starts work.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Correction: no new body is needed; the lens proposed one. No flood death in the North zone was found on record, so this action rests on losses and on the national warning record, not on a local death toll.

7. Before 30 November, clear the local drains at the Land Drainage Master Plan's flood spots in each district, and confirm which northern refuge centres are open and stocked

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
The two District Councils, with the LDA coordinating, the Road Development Authority, and the NDRRMC	30 November 2026	Existing operating budgets	Blocked drains flooding homes in the first heavy rain after a long dry spell

The Land Drainage Master Plan, published in August 2025, counts 306 flood-prone areas, about 50 of them high-risk. Under the 2017 Land Drainage Authority Act, the Authority coordinates and oversees drains that local authorities build and clean; the Road Development Authority clears road drains. This is the North's share of the national pre-season campaign. Refuge centres exist (about 3,000 people used them in December 2019), but no list of the North's centres was found, so the NDRRMC should confirm which are open and stocked.

Corrections: the named spots the lens proposed (L'Amitié, "Grand Baie low points") could not be found in the Master Plan, so the action names the Plan's own sites instead. Grand Baie and Pereybère fall under the Rivière du Rempart District Council.

8. By 30 November, prepare the list of northern Social Register households that the national trigger-cash line pays first: Rs 5,000 each, by bank transfer, on an MMS warning

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PHILANTHROPIST · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: PRECEDENT (BANGLADESH, 2021)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Social Integration, Social Security and National Solidarity, through NEF	Priority list by 30 November 2026	Draws on the national line MU-F01; not counted in this envelope	Families selling assets or skipping meals while waiting for proof of loss

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Every household payment in Mauritius moves after the event. After the rains of 15 March 2026 on Rodrigues, Rs 2.795M was announced on 4 April, about three weeks later, paid by bank transfer off a list built after the event: Rs 795k from NEF and Rs 2M from the National Solidarity Fund for 200 families. That combined run is the largest comparable payout on record. One national rule now covers all six zones: Rs 5,000 a Social Register household per trigger (the NEF basic-needs grant), paid by NEF and the NSF, capped at Rs 2.8M (about 560 households) per trigger, on an MMS Class II cyclone warning or an MMS heavy-rain warning. Main-island warnings cover the whole island, so the North shares one cap with every other zone, and NEF decides the allocation at the trigger from lists the zones prepare in advance. The North's job is its list: northern Social Register households, ranked, with bank details checked, before the season. The Adaptation Inventory's closest precedent is anticipatory cash before floods in Bangladesh (2021), where going a day without eating fell by 36%.

Corrections: the lens proposed 1,000 households at Rs 10,000 (Rs 10.0M); verification cut it to 250 households, and the set audit of 14 October moved it to the national line (MU-F01, rule MU-02), because all zones' warnings fire together on one channel. The North's earlier trigger, La Nicolière below 20%, was considered and not adopted: the national rule stays weather-only this season, because no payment in Mauritius has ever been made on a reservoir level. NEF holding money in escrow is not an established arrangement.

9. Register northern planters with the Small Farmers Welfare Fund before 1 December, and ask Cabinet to pre-announce a drought-loss rule

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ECONOMIST · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · FRONTLINE · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Agro-Industry, with the SFWF and FAREI	1 December 2026	Enrolment: staff time. Any payout: a Cabinet decision	Planters abandoning the season because they cannot carry the risk

Northern growers have been on two irrigation days a week since November 2025, and since August 2026 the Irrigation Authority has cut deliveries to vegetable growers from 50–60,000 to about 25,000 m³ and urged farmers to delay replanting. Most rent their land. The Crop Loss Compensation Scheme pays on losses that officers assess in the field, and no drought cover was found. The model is Cyclone Belal: on 19 January 2024 Cabinet paid a one-off Rs 10,000 per arpent to every non-sugar planter registered with the SFWF (Rs 130M in all). Registration was what made a planter eligible. So the cheap step is registration now, and the decision is whether Cabinet announces in advance what it will pay if the dry spell runs to February.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the Belal payment was a Cabinet decision, not a payout under the scheme, and a payout tied to La Nicolière has no basis in the scheme. The North's share of national vegetable output is not published; one grower leader puts 70% on the plateau and in the South, so this is a livelihood action more than a national food one.

10. From December, track all-cause deaths among people aged 60 and over, monthly, with the two districts pooled

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Health and Wellness, with Statistics Mauritius	First report in January 2027	Staff time and a data-sharing agreement	Deaths from heat, disease, or supply failure going unseen until it is too late to act

In 2006 the chikungunya epidemic coincided with 743 excess deaths that showed only in all-cause mortality, not in case counts. Deaths are registered within 24 hours and counted at district-council level; each district records roughly 700–750 deaths a year (secondary source, 2011–13). Use a 2015–2025 baseline that leaves out 2020–22. This pairs with the arbovirus care protocol proposed in the Port Louis briefing, which is national.

Correction: weekly is not realistic. At about 60 deaths a month per district, a 20% excess is roughly 10 deaths, which noise would swamp, so pool the two districts and report monthly.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	CWA	WRU	Irrigation Authority	MoHW	District Councils	Village Councils & community	NDRRMC	LDA / RDA	MSI / NEF	Agro-Industry / SFWF
1. Midlands release rule and rota steps	**A/R**	**R**	**C**		**I**	**I**				**I**
2. Priority tanker roster	**A/R**			**R**	**I**		**C**			
3. Boreholes, abstraction cap, chloride log	**A/R**	**R**	**C**							
4. "Covered" storage, voucher lid condition, sweeps	**R**			**A**	**R**	**R**				
5. Outage reporters, buddies, tanker log	**I**				**C**	**A/R**				
6. Local activation rule					**A/R**	**I**	**C**	**C**		
7. Drains and refuge centres					**A/R**		**R**	**R**		
8. Priority list for the national trigger cash	**C**					**R**	**C**		**A/R**	
9. Planter registration and drought-loss rule			**C**			**R**				**A/R**
10. Monthly 60+ death watch				**A/R**	**I**					

What the chart shows: the CWA is accountable for the three actions that keep water flowing (1–3), and the District Councils for the two that prepare for the rains (6–7). In row 4 the District Councils do the sweeps, but the Ministry of Health holds the A. Five rows need a decision rather than money: the release rule (1), the roster (2), the lid condition (4), the activation rule (6), and the cash priority list (8). Statistics Mauritius (row 10) and FAREI (row 9) also hold roles but are not given columns. WRU = Water Resources Unit; MoHW = Ministry of Health and Wellness; NDRRMC = National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Centre; LDA = Land Drainage Authority; RDA = Road Development Authority; MSI = Ministry of Social Integration, Social Security and National Solidarity; NEF = National Empowerment Foundation; SFWF = Small Farmers Welfare Fund.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

Rs 0.6M (about $12k)

TARGET

Rs 5.28M (about $110k)

CEILING

Rs 5.28M (about $110k)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

The price and count of lids: no Mauritian quote exists

At the MRA customs rate of Rs 48.1061 per US dollar (week 41, 12 October 2026). **Floor** = a 1,000-household lid pilot through the Ministry of Health, Rs 0.6M. **Target** = the Ministry's lids at scale, 7,800 households (Rs 4.68M in all, including the pilot) + EPCO, 1,000 households (Rs 0.6M) = Rs 5.28M, for about 8,800 households. The Ministry's scale-up is released only after it confirms in writing, by 15 November, that it can

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

spend the money (one check covering the Ministry's placements in this briefing, Port Louis, and the East and South). **Ceiling** = the target. With the cash moved to the national line, no further placement passed verification, and delivery, not money, binds above it. Trigger cash for action 8 draws on the national line MU-F01 and is **not counted in this envelope**. **The target fell 72%** from the panel's Rs 19.0M: in verification, hospital water continuity (Rs 3.0M) was cut as a statutory duty the Ministry and the CWA already carry, chlorine tablets (Rs 1.0M) as evidence that does not transfer to a piped, chlorinated supply, and the cash pool from Rs 10.0M to Rs 2.5M, giving Rs 7.5M; the set audit then moved the cash to the national line. The lid line is now the whole envelope, and both its unit price (Rs 600 a household, the set's common assumption) and its count (about 8,800 households, about 9.5% of the zone's 92,657 subscribers) are assumptions. Unlike Port Louis, where it is held back, it stays in the target here because the North is on 6 hours a day, not 8, and carries the 2024 dengue record. It is still released only against a written quote from a Mauritian supplier and the Ministry's agreement to distribute.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Ministry of Health vector control, through area health centres, with Village Councils distributing	N-F1. Lids and mesh for tanks and drums, with the container sweep (action 4)	Rs 4.68M ($97k); Rs 0.6M pilot at the floor	Pre-positioned stock	Rs 600 a household for a kit (lid or cover, mesh, larvicide only where safe) × 7,800 households: an assumption, as no Mauritian price for a lid, mesh cover, or lidded drum could be found. Floor: a 1,000-household pilot. Scale-up at target, released after the Ministry of Health confirms in writing by 15 November that it can spend it, and only against a written supplier quote. Not in any budget line found*	UNVERIFIED
EPCO (Environmental Protection & Conservation Organisation), Grand Gaube	N-F3. Lids and covered storage in Grand Gaube and Poudre d'Or (action 4)	Rs 0.6M ($12k)	Direct grant	Rs 600 a household (assumption) × 1,000 households. Global Affairs Canada funded EPCO's water-storage tanks for five coastal villages in 2018 (18,260 in the grant record). No project found after 2021, so release only after a call confirms it is active, and against a written supplier quote	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
National Empowerment Foundation and National Solidarity Fund (national line MU-F01)	Trigger cash for northern Social Register households (action 8)	Not counted in this envelope	Cash transfer (national)	Draws on the national trigger-cash line MU-F01 (Rs 5,000 a household, Rs 2.8M cap per trigger, shared by all six zones): **not counted in this envelope**. The cap matches the largest comparable payout on record, Rs 2.795M to Rodrigues after the rains of 15 March 2026 (NEF Rs 795k + NSF Rs 2M)	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

The funder's one thing: the most leverage on this page is not a grant. It is the condition on the state's Rs 15,000 tank voucher. A small co-funding offer that requires every subsidised tank to have a sealed lid and a mesh inlet changes how the whole programme is spent. Without it, the drought response becomes a mosquito-breeding programme in the districts that were the last to shake off dengue in 2024.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not give vegetable plots a third irrigation day from La Nicolière

CONTRAINDICATED

A lens proposed it to save the planting window. The Northern Plains irrigation scheme draws on La Nicolière, the same reservoir that gives about 90,000–95,000 northern residents their drinking water. A third day takes water straight from households, and "paying for it by keeping cane suspended" frees nothing, because cane has been suspended since November 2025.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: keep potable supply first. Register planters with the SFWF (action 9), and fund drip lines, mulch, and seed for planting once the rains start.

Do not drill new coastal boreholes, or raise coastal abstraction, without a chloride baseline

CONTRAINDICATED

The northern aquifers are young, permeable lava connected to the sea at the coast. The model that would show how much they can safely give is not finished (UNESCO, to March 2027). Salt drawn into a coastal aquifer this season stays there long after the rains.

Instead: bring private and tested inland boreholes into supply first, and log chloride monthly at every borehole (action 3).

Do not promise desalination as this season's fix

CONTRAINDICATED

The northern plant is at feasibility-study stage: an expression of interest opened in September 2025 for a 50,000 m³/day plant, and the study runs 12 months before any tender. Water already costs the CWA Rs 24/m³ to produce against Rs 14/m³ sold, and a former CWA chief engineer warns desalination could push costs toward Rs 100/m³. A promise for March would displace the actions that work now.

Instead: the release rule, the roster, and private boreholes (actions 1–3).

Do not tell households to "store water" without saying "covered", or put larvicide in drinking water

CONTRAINDICATED

Six hours of supply a day means every household stores water, and open containers are where *Ae. albopictus* breeds. No approval was found for larvicide in stored drinking water in Mauritius.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: "store water covered, scrub weekly"; larvicide only in containers that do not hold drinking water, unless the Ministry of Health approves otherwise (action 4).*

Do not make insecticide fogging the visible response to dengue or chikungunya

CONTRAINDICATED

A systematic review of 15 studies found space spraying's effect on mosquito numbers short-lived, with no evidence of an effect on disease; a 2016 meta-analysis found no randomised trials of fogging against dengue. No data on local insecticide resistance has been published.

Instead: remove and cover breeding sites, and keep spraying for case clusters.

Do not frame this season as an "El Niño drought"

CONTRAINDICATED

By the NOAA index, the North's dated water failures fell in La Niña years (1998–99, 2011–12, 2017–18) or a cool-neutral one (2025–26). The shortage is structural: one reservoir, one transfer from Midlands, aquifers running 30% below normal, and a utility with a Rs 755M deficit. The MMS bulletin of 10 August 2026 gives October–December rain about 92% of normal (near-normal to slightly dry), warmer than normal, and the regional forecast for January–March 2027 is normal to above-normal rain. Calling it El Niño invites one-season fixes and primes people for drought just as the flood and mosquito season begins.

Instead: "a structural water shortfall, made worse by a dry year, followed by the rain and mosquito season".

Do not fund chlorine tablets or hospital water contingencies

CONTRAINDICATED

The panel proposed both. The North's water, including tanker water, is piped mains water that the CWA treats, and the evidence for chlorine tablets comes from places with untreated water and high child mortality. Hospital water supply is a statutory duty the Ministry of Health and the CWA already carry and budget for. Paying for either moves money away from the gaps nobody covers.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: put the money into lids (N-F1), and make the hospital roster a signed decision (action 2).

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1867	Malaria epidemic; a Pamplemousses observatory site was later called too "unhealthy" to keep	About 40,000 deaths, roughly a tenth of the island's population (1867); no district count	Not recorded
1929	La Nicolière reservoir built	—	Its treatment plant was raised from 10,000 to 70,000 m³/day in the 1990s
Feb 1960	Cyclones Alix and Carol	8 and 42 dead island-wide	"Cyclone-proof" cités
Feb 1975	Cyclone Gervaise (La Niña)	9–10 dead island-wide	Not recorded
1998–99	Record drought (strong La Niña)	Sugar crop about 340,000 t against 625,000 t potential	Midlands dam, completed 2002, to top up La Nicolière
Jan 2002	Cyclone Dina; island-wide power loss	4 dead on Mauritius (secondary sources)	Not recorded
2011–12	Drought (La Niña); January 2012 rain 88 mm against 261 mm normal	Northern planters farmed less than a third of their land	Drought Period Regulations 2011
Dec 2017	La Nicolière at 39.2% (La Niña); Grand Gaube, Calodyne, and Pereybère on tankers	No deaths recorded	Not recorded

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Jan 2018	Cyclone Berguitta	No deaths; 223 displaced nationally	Ended the sterile-mosquito pilot's effect at Panchvati
2023–24	Record dengue outbreak (El Niño summer); Rivière du Rempart and Pamplemousses among the last three areas affected in June 2024	3,311 cases on the main island and 1,363 on Rodrigues, with 4 deaths, to 19 March 2024 (WHO AFRO); then about 7,177 cases and 15 deaths nationally by 28 April (TravelHealthPro, secondary). The government's own figure is 6,673 cases and 8 deaths (June 2024)	Fogging; no lid rule
Nov 2025	La Nicolière at 45% (cool-neutral); food crops cut to two irrigation days a week, cane suspended	Vegetable prices forecast up 15–25%	Boreholes and tankers
2026	La Nicolière 45.8% at end-September 2026 against 75.7% a year earlier; supply 6 hours a day under the CWA schedule of 5 August; El Niño developing; MMS bulletin of 10 August: October–December rain about 92% of normal, warmer than normal	No deaths recorded	Too early to say

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the North fails before the rains, not during them, and in La Niña years, not El Niño ones. La Nicolière reached about 45% on 27 October 2025 and the same level (45.8%) at end-September 2026, a month earlier. That makes this the first back-to-back failure on record, and since 2002 the North's taps have depended on rain falling on the central plateau, not on the North itself.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Drill more boreholes now** (Historian, Emergency manager) versus **do not drill coastal boreholes blind** (Skeptic). Reconciled as private and inland boreholes first, with a coastal cap and a chloride log. The aquifer model due in March 2027 would settle how far to go.
- **Water the planting window** (Food supply chain: "January's shortage is decided in the next six weeks") versus **drinking water first** (verification). Same reservoir, so the third irrigation day was contraindicated. The cost is real: planters are being told to delay replanting, and the North's incomes carry it.

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- **Heat and fever warnings for people over 60** (Public health) versus **the evidence does not transfer** (verification: Ahmedabad's alerts start above 40°C and northern Mauritius summers peak lower). The monthly death watch (action 10) would show whether heat is killing here.
- **Fund lids in the North** versus **hold them in Port Louis**. The two briefings treat the same unpriced line differently, on the North's shorter supply day and its dengue record. A single supplier quote would settle both.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens worked out how many days of supply the North has left. La Nicolière fell about 9.5 points in September, Midlands about 3 points, and a hydrologist advises planning for no useful rain before early February. Nobody combined the reservoir volumes, the transfer rate from Midlands, the borehole output, and the current draw into a date. That one number decides whether actions 1 and 2 are precautions or the main event, and whether the national cash rule behind action 8 needs a water-supply trigger as well as its MMS warnings. The CWA and the Water Resources Unit hold every input.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale. The North sits in MUS.R8e39d7d595d97ac3 (label unconfirmed), the rest of the main island plus Rodrigues, about 850,000 people, so any figure would not be a zone figure. The Climate Impact Lab publishes none for Mauritius. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as the Central Water Authority's North supply zone, one of six Mauritius briefings aligned to CWA supply zones (decision of 13 October 2026). Its localities come from the CWA's hours-of-supply schedule of 13 January 2025; one 2021 article places Terre Rouge on the Pailles (Port Louis) system instead. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it:

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MUS.R8e39d7d595d97ac3 (label unconfirmed), decoded from the Impact Map's boundary file. Mauritius has only three impact regions, and this one covers the whole island outside Port Louis and Plaines Wilhems, plus Rodrigues, about 850,000 people, so any figure for it would blend the North with the East, South, and Rodrigues. The label the map displays was not confirmed in a live browser. Sub-zone detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only and publishes no figure for Mauritius. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not the dominant hazard here, so the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. The national context (reservoir levels, the 2026 chikungunya epidemic, the absence of pre-arranged risk finance, the payment rails) was taken from the Port Louis briefing of the same day, where it was verified, and re-checked where it was local.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents (water supply, health, flood and cyclone, finance, food, and the funding envelope) checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. A reported La Nicolière level of 6% on 3 October was traced to a dropped digit and replaced with 45.8% at end-September 2026 (Water Resources Commission and CWA). ENSO phases were checked against NOAA's Oceanic Niño Index.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.

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- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted. The full dataset (96 entries) is embedded in the inventory page and was parsed from there. It holds no entry for Mauritius, any small island state, water rationing, boreholes, tankers, or vector-borne disease. The one relevant precedent is anticipatory cash before floods in Bangladesh (2021), tagged on action 8. "None found" on the other actions means the inventory was searched and holds nothing comparable.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (larvicide and stored drinking water) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Much of the 2026 record reaches us through Mauritian press (L'Express via AllAfrica, Defimedia), and several pages returned HTTP 403, so some figures were confirmed from search indexing only. No list of the North's refuge centres, no district breakdown of vegetable production, no Mauritian price for a tank lid, and no published Midlands release rule were found. The age structure of the two districts was not found. The CWA supply-zone boundaries were not available.
- **Revised 2026-10-14 after the set audit** (fixes applied: 1, impact region labelled unconfirmed and sized; 2, trigger cash moved to the national line MU-F01 and the zone's own cash placement removed; 3, lids at Rs 600 a household with a 1,000-household pilot before the Ministry of Health check; 4, national items cross-referenced in the map data; 5, all US dollar figures restated at Rs 48.1061; 6, two-stage dengue figures; 9, MMS forecast of 10 August added; 10, the 1867 toll, the 9 October tank voucher, and the population basis; 27, about 8,800 lid households; 28, La Nicolière dated end-September 2026 throughout; 29, the RACI note on row 4). Fixes 7 and 8 do not touch this briefing. The envelope is now Rs 0.6M / 5.28M / 5.28M.

References (✓ verified by a verifier agent against the primary source · ~ partly verified or secondary · ? not verified) · ✓ ION News, WRC reservoir levels, 29 Sep 2026 · ~ Defimedia, reservoir levels, Oct 2026 (the "6%" misprint) · ✓ L'Express, La Nicolière and hydrologist's advice, 29 Sep 2026 · ✓ Defimedia, WRC–CWA communiqué, 30 Jul 2026 · ✓ CWA communiqué, 30 Jul 2026 · ✓ CWA, new supply hours from 5 Aug 2026 · ✓ CWA, hours of supply by locality, Jan 2025 · ✓ CWA Annual Report 2024-25 · ✓ L'Express, interview with the CWA's acting head on groundwater and Midlands, 3 Aug 2026 · ✓ L'Express, CWA tanker fleet, 12 Oct 2026 · ✓ CWA, registration of private tankers, 6 Oct 2026 · ~ Defimedia, CWA requisitions private boreholes · ~ Water Power Magazine, Midlands dam and feeder canal · ✓ UNESCO project 218MAR2000, Northern Aquifer model · ✓ UKZN thesis, Mauritius aquifer chemistry · ✓ Ground Water Regulations 2011 (GN 240/2011) · ~ Ground Water (Amendment) Regulations 2015 · ✓

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L'Express, Pereybère outage, 5 May 2026 · ✓ L'Express, Grand Gaube outage, 13 Feb 2026 · ✓ L'Express, CWA tanker investigation, Feb 2025 · ✓ AllAfrica, dengue: last affected areas, 28 Jun 2024 · ✓ WHO AFRO, dengue outbreak, 21 Mar 2024 · ✓ L'Express, chikungunya hotspots, May 2026 · ✓ Bowman et al. 2016, dengue vector control meta-analysis · ✓ Esu et al. 2010, space spraying review · ✓ Iyaloo et al., sterile insect pilot at Panchvati (Peer Community Journal) · ✓ Cochrane 2024, antibiotics for leptospirosis · ✓ L'Express, leptospirosis cases, 13 May 2026 · ✓ Beesoon et al., Chikungunya, Mauritius, 2006 (EID 2008) · ~ Deaths by district, Mauritius (secondary) · ✓ EY, Mauritius Budget 2026-27 synopsis · ✓ Africa Press, tank and pump grant rules · ✓ AllAfrica, water tank grants, Feb 2025 · ✓ 5plus, Cabinet extends the tank grant as a Rs 15,000 voucher, 10 Oct 2026 (press; scheme rules not published) · ✓ UNDP, Rivière du Rempart community hub, Sep 2025 · ✓ Stimson CORVI 2024, citing GFDRR 2017 · ✓ National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act 2016 · ~ MMS warning thresholds (PreventionWeb, 2009) · ✓ Land Drainage Authority Act 2017 · ✓ L'Express, Land Drainage Master Plan, Aug 2025 · ✓ Defimedia, refuge centres, Dec 2019 · ✓ Dartmouth Flood Observatory, Berguitta 2018 · ✓ L'Express, northern desalination feasibility study, Mar 2026 · ✓ L'Express, desalination and dams, Jul 2026 · ✓ L'Express, CWA deficit and production cost, 1 Jul 2026 · ✓ L'Express, former CWA chief engineer on desalination cost, Jul 2026 · ✓ NOAA CPC, Oceanic Niño Index · ✓ SARCOF-33 statement, Aug 2026 · ✓ L'Express, NEF payments after the Rodrigues floods, 16 Apr 2026 · ✓ Pople et al., anticipatory cash before floods, Bangladesh (Adaptation Inventory) · ✓ Crop Loss Compensation Scheme · ✓ Cabinet decisions, 19 Jan 2024 (Belal planter payment) · ✓ L'Express, fishers' bad-weather allowance, May 2026 · ✓ L'Express, irrigation restrictions, 27 Oct 2025 · ✓ L'Express, Small Planters Association, 16 Nov 2025 · ✓ L'Express, Irrigation Authority urges delayed replanting, Aug 2026 · ✓ Le Mauricien, irrigation deliveries cut, 2026 · ✓ L'Express, vegetable production by region, 22 May 2026 · ✓ AMB, daily National Wholesale Market prices · ✓ Global Affairs Canada grant to EPCO, 2018 · ✓ Actogether, EPCO profile · ~ IPS, As the taps run dry in Mauritius, 2012 · ~ Defimedia, reservoirs and tankers, Dec 2017 · ✓ AFD, 40 years of water collaboration · ✓ Seetah, malaria in Mauritius (Springer) · ✓ Seetah, Empire, environment and disease: an Indian Ocean case study (41,000 deaths, 1867) · ✓ Université de La Réunion, the 1867 malaria epidemic (about 40,000 of 333,000) · ✓ US government note on Cyclone Gervaise, Feb 1975 · ~ Africa Press, Cyclone Dina toll · ~ The Spectator, cyclones Alix and Carol, 1960 · ✓ MRA rate of exchange, week 41 of 2026 (Rs 48.1061, 12 Oct) · ✓ L'Express via AllAfrica, Rs 2.795M relief to Rodrigues (NEF Rs 795k + NSF Rs 2M), 4 Apr 2026 · ✓ L'Express, MMS El Niño bulletin of 10 Aug 2026 · ~ TravelHealthPro, dengue 7,177 cases, Apr 2024 (secondary) · ✓ Climate Impact Lab, impact region boundaries · ✓ Port Louis, Mauritius El Niño action briefing, 13 Oct 2026 (national context) · Storm research: Mauritius briefing scope and map design, 13 Oct 2026 (internal)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 13 October 2026 for the North zone, Mauritius; revised 14 October 2026 after the set audit. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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